

SWEN90016

Software Processes and Management

Lecture 4 – Addendum

**Common Senior Executive Roles
Stakeholder Management**

*Faculty of Engineering and Information Technology
School of Computing and Information Systems*

The University of Melbourne acknowledges the Traditional Owners of the unceded land on which we work, learn and live: the Wurundjeri Woi-wurrung and Bunurong peoples (Burnley, Fishermans Bend, Parkville, Southbank and Werribee campuses), the Yorta Yorta Nation (Dookie and Shepparton campuses), and the Dja Dja Wurrung people (Creswick campus).

The University also acknowledges and is grateful to the Traditional Owners, Elders and Knowledge Holders of all Indigenous nations and clans who have been instrumental in our reconciliation journey.

We recognise the unique place held by Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples as the original owners and custodians of the lands and waterways across the Australian continent, with histories of continuous connection dating back more than 60,000 years. We also acknowledge their enduring cultural practices of caring for Country.

We pay respect to Elders past, present and future, and acknowledge the importance of Indigenous knowledge in the Academy. As a community of researchers, teachers, professional staff and students we are privileged to work and learn every day with Indigenous colleagues and partners.



Common senior executive roles explained — CEO

CEO — Chief Executive Officer

- Top-ranking executive (below the Board of Directors and the Chair of the Board of Directors)
- Very specific leadership role that goes beyond merely coordinating with other C-level executives
 - Is the face of the company to shareholders, investors, the public and other companies
 - Has a direct line of accountability to the Board of Directors
 - Is ultimately responsible for the overall success of the organization and as the final say in key decisions that affect the entire company (hence high power and high interest)
 - Has oversight of all other areas (e.g., operations, finance, technology, research, personnel)
 - Has the authority to make decisions that override the recommendations of other C-level executives
- The CEO can only be dismissed by the Chair of the Board, following a decision by the Board of Directors

[The C-Suite in Healthcare Organizations](#) (Some of these roles are presented in the Medic Case Study)



Common senior executive roles explained — CFO

CFO — Chief Financial Officer

- Responsible for the strategic management of the company's financial resources, which include financial planning, risk management, record-keeping, and financial reporting
- Focused on the company's fiscal health, maintaining liquidity, and optimizing capital structure to support the strategic objectives of the company
- Has high power and influence over the financial policy and decision-making process within the company
 - Allocation of financial resources, assessment of investment opportunities, management of financial risks
 - Development of strategies to maximize shareholder value
- Communicates financial performance and forecasts to the Board of Directors, investors, and regulatory bodies



Common senior executive roles explained — COO

COO — Chief Operating Officer

- Responsible for the day-to-day operations of the company
- Focused on business operations being efficient and effective
 - Allocation of financial resources, assessment of investment opportunities, management of financial risks
 - Development of strategies to maximize shareholder value
- Has significant...
 - Power over the implementation of projects and the optimization of processes
 - Interest in making sure that the company meets its operational goals
- Typical reporting includes operational efficiency, execution of company-wide initiatives, performance metrics, operational risk management, overall resource allocation, operational budget, compliance and regulatory adherence



Common senior executive roles explained — CIO

CIO — Chief Information (Technology) Officer

- Responsible for the information technology (IT) strategy and infrastructure of the company
- Ensures that IT systems and technologies align with business objectives and support operational efficiency (COO), innovation (CTO), and competitive advantage (CEO)
- Steers the selection of technologies, management of IT resources, cybersecurity measures, data governance, and the overall digital capabilities of the company
- Has significant...
 - Power over information technology direction and digital strategy
 - Interest in the company's IT infrastructure meeting current and future business needs
- Collaborates closely with the Chief Technology Officer (CTO)



Common senior executive roles explained — CTO

CTO — Chief Technology Officer

- Responsible for the overall technological ‘stack’ of the company (which includes any technology used to produce any of the goods and services it produces)
- Ensures that technologies in the company align with business objectives and support operational efficiency (COO), information efficiency (CIO), and competitive advantage (CEO)
- Ensures the development and implementation of technologies that support the company’s product offerings and long-term goals
 - Research and development (R&D) effort
 - Technological innovation and technology infrastructure scales with the business
- Has significant...
 - Power over the technological ‘stack’ direction of the company
 - Interest in the technology infrastructure scaling to meet company’s overall objectives
- Collaborates closely with the Chief Information (Technology) Officer (CIO)
 - Often CIO and CTO interests overlap over IT



Common senior executive roles explained — CMO

CMO — Chief Medical Officer

- Responsible for the medical and clinical aspects of a healthcare provider
- Ensures quality and effectiveness of patient care, alignment of medical practices with the provider's strategic goals
- Ensures the development and implementation of practices that support medical strategy, clinical practices, quality and compliance, patient support
- Has significant...
 - Power over clinical direction (e.g., decisions on medical practices, patient care protocols, allocation of resources for clinical services)
 - Interest in highest standards of patient care, reputation for clinical excellence, aligning medical practices with ethical and legal standards



Common roles explained

Product Manager

- Define the products that engineering teams will design, build, test and hand over to sales.
- They connect strategic levels of the company, business and technology areas
- Power: Product managers have significant influence over a product's roadmap and success
- Interest: Build products that meet customer needs and drive business value (aligned with strategic product roadmaps defined at higher levels in the company)
- Works closely with project managers, business and technology managers



Common roles explained

Project Manager

- Defines, plans and executes projects that will build products defined by Product Managers
- Work across several areas of the company, including business and technology (as required by the type of products that their projects are building)
- Power: Allocate, direct and coordinate resources, manage timelines, manage project financials, manage product- and project-related stakeholders. Power is derived from the executives owning and sponsoring the creation of the product.
- Interest: Successful delivery of the projects they manage
- Works closely with product managers, business and technology managers

WARNING

This material has been reproduced and communicated to you by or on behalf of the University of Melbourne in accordance with section 113P of the *Copyright Act 1968 (Act)*.

The material in this communication may be subject to copyright under the Act.

Any further reproduction or communication of this material by you may be the subject of copyright protection under the Act.

Do not remove this notice